



Inclusive Academics

Working With Faculty and Instructors to Support Academic Access for
Students with Intellectual Disability

Chelsea VanHorn Stinnett, PhD



1



Hi, I'm Chelsea!

- Former paraprofessional/K-12 educator.
- Former postsecondary education (PSE) program....everything.
- Current technical assistance coordinator for Think College.
- Current faculty member in special education.
- Always: a person with support needs in higher education.



2

Who are you?



3

Objectives

As a result of attending this session, participants will be able to:

- Describe the vital role that collaborating with faculty in achieving success plays in inclusive postsecondary education.
- Use pragmatic approaches to strengthen the capabilities of faculty and instructors in addressing the needs of a diverse student population.
- Use advanced engagement techniques to foster effective collaboration with faculty and instructors.
- Develop a strategic plan for implementing collaborative practices within their academic environment.



4

Rate Your Understanding!

Drop a number 1-4, rate your understanding of strategies to facilitate academic success in inclusive college coursework.

1- Barely any, that's why I'm here!

2- I understand a little bit.

3- I understand what works well, but I'm always down for new ideas.

4- I know pretty much all there is to know, I'm just here to confirm that I know everything.



5

Building Context



Postsecondary education (PSE) programs are not new, but are a growing sub-field of higher education.



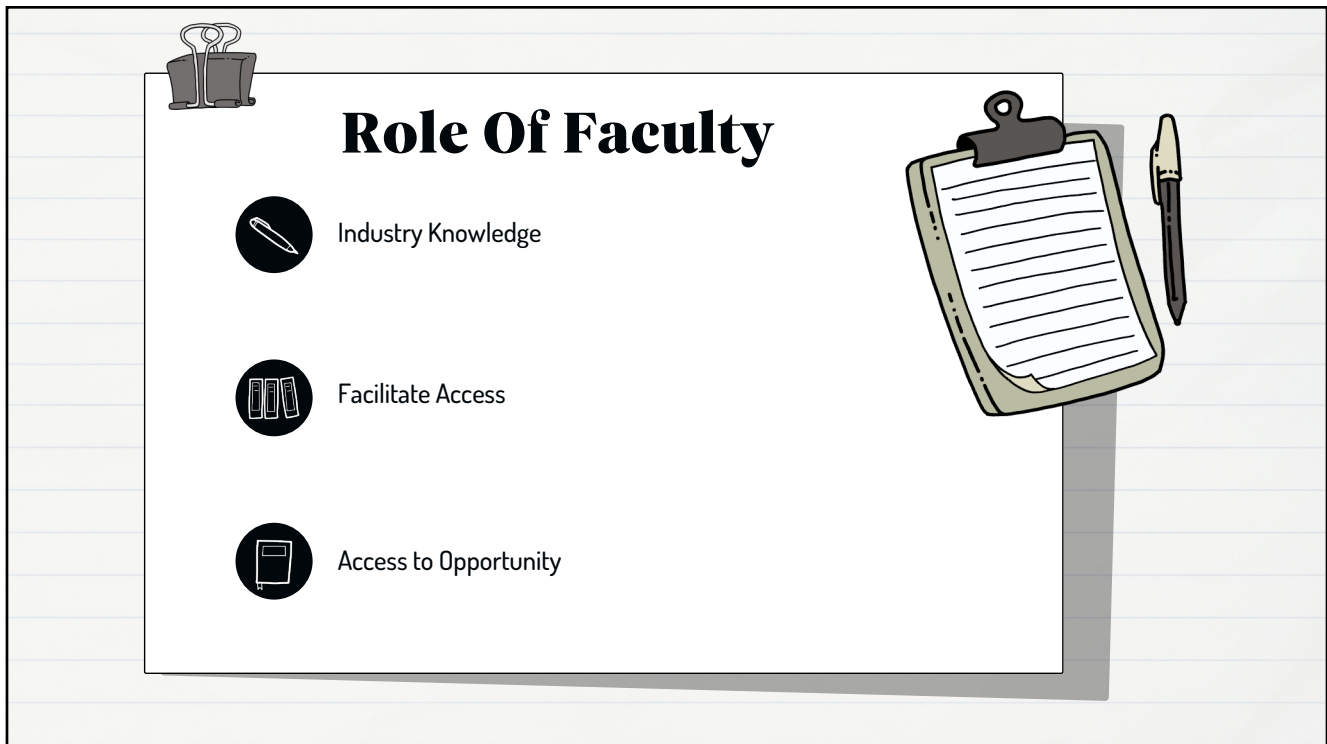
Over 333 programs across the country.



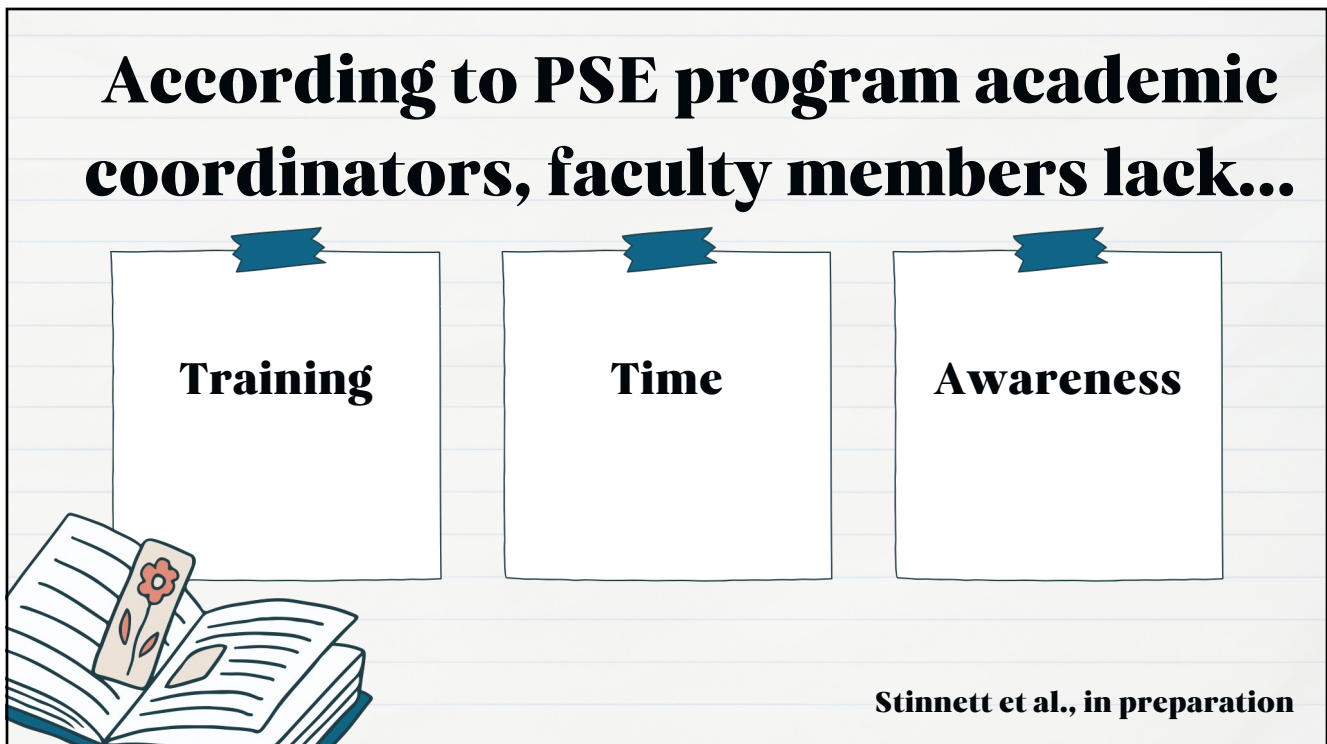
Audit and a growing number of degree-seeking students, utilizing accommodations and modifications.



6

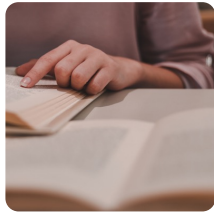


7



8

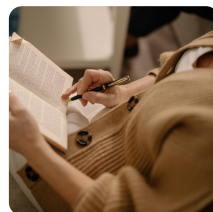
According to faculty members, they...



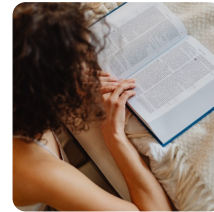
Are motivated by their own connection to disability, "walking the walk," and curiosity.



Lack confidence, orientation, and support from PSE programs.



Find value for all classroom community members in taking a more universal approach to teaching.



Feel IPSE has led to personal reflection and growth in pedagogy.

Choiseul-Praslin et al., in preparation

9

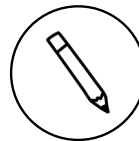
Working with Faculty and Instructors to Support Academic Success



Building Program Awareness and Buy-In Across Campus



Effective Orientation and Training Opportunities



Communicating Needs and Mutual Expectations



Implementing Practical Strategies and Modifications



10



Building Program Awareness and Buy-In Across Campus

What is it?	Why is it important?
Proactively building awareness of the program and needs of people with intellectual disability across campus.	Faculty can be hesitant towards the unfamiliar, might be unaware of students' support needs and the support that exists for IPSE on campus.



11



Building Program Awareness and Buy-In Across Campus

Scenario:

Faculty and instructors have never heard about inclusive postsecondary education and didn't even know a program for students with intellectual disability existed on this campus.

Potential Solution:

Develop a social media and/or tabling presence on campus. Remember that students are the experts and the best advocates to share their lived experiences and perspectives.

12



Building Program Awareness and Buy-In Across Campus

Scenario:

Faculty and instructors have heard about your program, but don't really know purpose it serves and their role in teaching students with intellectual disability.

Potential Solution:

Develop a clear and concise one-pager that details key elements of your program, specifically highlighting the purpose. Consider a QR code that links directly to your social media or website.

13



Building Program Awareness and Buy-In Across Campus

Scenario:

Faculty and instructors have never heard about the program or their peers' experiences in working collaboratively to meet the needs of students.

Potential Solution:

Highlight faculty partners on your social media. Tag your college/university. The more faculty and instructors hear and see their peers engaging with the program, the more they are likely to know about the program and be receptive to partnerships.

14



Effective Orientation and Training Opportunities

What is it?	Why is it important?
Providing training and capacity-building opportunities for faculty and instructors to have the skills (confidence!) to meet the needs of diverse learners, including those with intellectual disability.	Faculty report a lack of support and training, program professional report faculty lack time and commitment to program-specific training. We have to find some ways to fill the gaps!



15



Effective Orientation and Training Opportunities

Scenario:

Faculty and instructors express that they don't feel confident in meeting the needs of students with intellectual disability in their courses.

Potential Solutions:

Provide data! Create training opportunities that faculty and instructors can access in different modalities and lengths.

16



Effective Orientation and Training Opportunities

Scenario:

Faculty and instructors are hesitant to dedicate additional time to training specific to meeting the needs of students with intellectual disability. What's in it for them?

Potential Solution:

Partner with your Center for Teaching and Learning to develop an inclusive teaching certificate that faculty can use to meet the needs of several diverse learners AND faculty can put this certification on their CV!

17



Effective Orientation and Training Opportunities

Scenario:

Faculty and instructors are hesitant to listen to you because you lack similar credentials/roles within the university structure.

Potential Solution:

Partner with department chairs/school directors, who supervise faculty and can help to bridge the gap. Consider implementing a Faculty Advisory Board.

18



Communicating Needs and Mutual Expectations

What is it?	Why is it important?
Bridging the gap between program, student, and faculty communications to understand each partners' role and expectations in academic coursework.	Several issues identified by faculty/program staff are a result of not understanding/communicating needs and expectations.



19



Communicating Needs and Mutual Expectations

Scenario:
Program staff members are unaware of the needs and experience of faculty and instructors in supporting students with intellectual disability.

Potential Solution:
Use a Faculty Needs Assessment to determine needs, expectations, and confidence in supporting students with intellectual disability.

20

Experience and Confidence in Working with People with Intellectual Disability:

	Yes	No	I'm Not Sure
I have had a student from the [insert program name here] enrolled in this course before.			
I have had a student from the [insert program name here] enrolled in one of the courses I've taught before.			
I have professional experience working with people with intellectual disability.			
I have personal experience in understanding the support needs of people with intellectual disability.			

21

Understanding of Program Expectations and Philosophy:

	Strongly Agree	Disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree	Not Applicable
I understand the purpose of [INSERT PROGRAM NAME HERE].					
I understand the academic expectations of students enrolled in [INSERT PROGRAM NAME HERE].					
I understand how my course connects to the student's personal and/or professional goals.					
I understand the difference between students' rights to accommodations and modifications that will be helpful in individualizing students' needs in my course.					

22

Faculty Communication and Support Preferences:

	Strongly Agree	Disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree	Not Applicable
<i>I would benefit from receiving more information about the following:</i>					
The student's individual needs and interests.					
Considerations around sharing information about students enrolled in [INSERT PROGRAM NAME HERE] in relation to FERPA.					
Disability rights, representation, and history.					
Strategies for increasing student participation.					
Strategies for modifying coursework activities and assignments.					

23



Communicating Needs and Mutual Expectations

Scenario:
Faculty and instructors didn't get the support they needed and are hesitant to partner with the program in the future because their needs weren't met.

Potential Solution:
Use an End of Semester Faculty Perspectives Assessment to determine which aspects of your communication/partnership with them needs to be refined for the future.

24

Student Completion of Course Goals and Assignments:

	Strongly Agree	Disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree	Not Applicable
The student successfully met the course objectives without modifications.					
The student successfully met modified course objections, specific to their own personal or professional goals.					
The student completed their required assignments within my expectations.					

25

Student Participation:

	Strongly Agree	Disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree	Not Applicable
The student attended class regularly and on-time.					
The student contributed meaningfully to course activities.					
The student adhered to the classroom expectations described in my syllabus.					
The student effectively advocated for accommodations and support, when needed.					
The student felt a sense of belonging in my course.					

26

Program Support of Faculty Instruction

	Strongly Agree	Disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree	Not Applicable
Overall, I am satisfied with the level of support provided to me by the program in effectively meeting the needs of the student.					
The program responded in a timely manner to my questions and requests for support.					
The role of program personnel in supporting the student throughout the semester was clear.					
The program provided me with effective strategies for increasing student engagement.					
The program provided me with effective strategies for modifying coursework, activities, and assignments.					

27

Faculty Perspectives on Teaching a Student Enrolled in [INSERT PROGRAM NAME]

	Strongly Agree	Disagree	Agree	Strongly Agree	Not Applicable
As a result of teaching this student this semester...					
I feel confident in meeting the needs of students with intellectual disability in future courses.					
I know more about the [INSERT PROGRAM NAME].					
I would recommend learning more about the [INSERT PROGRAM NAME] to my faculty peers.					
I would be willing to talk to reluctant faculty members about my positive experiences with the [INSERT PROGRAM NAME].					
The program provided me with effective support in creating accessible content.					

28

Communicating Needs and Mutual Expectations

Scenario:

Faculty and instructors have no idea what they could possibly modify about their course to meet the needs of students. It also sounds like a lot of work.

Potential Solution:

Prepare students to lead a conversation with faculty to discuss their support needs, goals, and potential modifications. Develop a course contract with faculty to determine which modifications will be made.

29


 UNIVERSITY OF SOUTH ALABAMA
 PASSAGE USA

Spring 2023

Student: _____
 Instructor: Dr. _____ BUS 150.102/ PSG 090-120 Intro to Business

Your partnership and input are crucial for the success of our program. A PASSAGE USA student will be auditing your course and will not receive academic credit. To track their progress as an auditing student, the number of contact hours and a final satisfactory or unsatisfactory grade per course needs to be recorded on the student's transcript. This information is part of the university's policy for determining whether a student enrolled in our two-year certificate program, which focuses on gainful employment through academic enrichment, is making Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) or not.

Inclusive Class Learning Contract

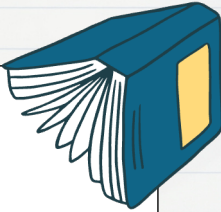
Date: January 9th, 2023

Last Name: xxxx	Name: xxxxx	Jag#: J00xxxxxx
Student Phone Number: 251.xxx.xxxx		Student Email: xxxxx@jagmail.southalabama.edu
Course: Bus 150		Semester: <u>Spring 2023</u>
Instructor: Dr. xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx		College of Business
Instructor Phone Number: 251-xxx-xxxx		Instructor Email: xxxxx@southalabama.edu

Learning Goals:

1. Student will arrive at class promptly, email the professor if sick, and follow the required attendance rules for the class.
2. Student will be a responsible student by paying attention, avoiding distractions, and participating in class.
3. Student will participate in the scheduled class meetings, as indicated in the syllabus.
4. The student will use a personal device for notetaking if the instructor allows it.
5. The student will be attentive during class presentations.
6. The student will participate in quizzes by the due date as specified in the syllabus with support as needed.
7. The student will participate in Defining Your Career Assignment by the due date as specified in the syllabus with support as needed.
8. The student will participate in The Extra Credit Survey by the due date as specified in the syllabus with support staff as needed.
9. The student will participate in the Get Connected Day Alternative by the due date as specified in the syllabus with support as needed.
10. The student will participate in the Pitch Vantage Assignment by the due date as specified in the syllabus with support as needed.
11. The student will participate in the Pitch Vantage Assignment by the due date as specified in the syllabus with support as needed.
12. The student will participate in SPI course Evaluation by the due date as specified in the syllabus with support as needed.

30



Implementing Practical Modifications and Strategies

What is it?	Why is it important?
Providing faculty and instructors with modification recommendations and strategies that are easy to implement and could benefit all students.	Faculty and instructors express a lack of time and understanding of implementing inclusive instructional design.

31



Implementing Practical Modifications and Strategies

Scenario:
Faculty don't want to make modifications because they are time consuming.

Potential Solution:
Modifications are often just "good teaching." Create a bank of common modifications/strategies that faculty can learn more about and implement.

32

Possible projects include:

- ☐ Inclusive practices for students with disabilities in early childhood education
- ☐ US disability rights history
- ☐ Global disability history
- ☐ Inclusive practices for K-12 classrooms
- ☐ The importance of self-determination for students with disabilities
- ☐ Building self-determination skills for students with disabilities
- ☐ Inclusive postsecondary education
- ☐ Co-teaching practices for the inclusive classroom
- ☐ Evidence-based predictors of postschool success for students with disabilities
- ☐ Sex education for youth and young adults with disabilities
- ☐ Person-first language versus identity-first language
- ☐ Accommodating student with disabilities in the (insert your future type of classroom) classroom
- ☐ Universal Design for Learning
- ☐ Current issues in disability rights
- ☐ The #BlackDisabledLivesMatter movement or implications of #BlackLivesMatter for youth with disabilities
- ☐ The school to prison pipeline for youth with disabilities
- ☐ Student-Directed IEP Meetings
- ☐ The role of the general education teacher in the IEP process

Selecting a topic not listed here is encouraged but only with prior approval from one of the course instructors.

Possible project formats include:

- ☐ Build a website.
- ☐ Create a screencast of a narrated PowerPoint/Google Slides/Prezi
- ☐ Create an infographic or brochure.
- ☐ Build an annotated teacher toolkit.
- ☐ Build an annotated student toolkit.
- ☐ Write a 5–7-page paper (double-spaced, 12 pt. font, 1" margins)
- ☐ Create a YouTube video on the topic

Selecting a project format not listed here requires prior approval from one of the course instructors.

33

The following rubric will be used to grade your project(s):

	Exemplary	Satisfactory	Needs Improvement
Definition/Explanation of the Topic	10 points Includes a thorough and correct definition/explanation of topic(s).	8 points Includes definition/explanation of topic(s) that is correct, but missing some key information.	5 points The definition/explanation of topic(s) lacks specificity and/or is incomplete/incorrect.
Relevance to Key Stakeholders	12 points Includes a description of the relevance of the topic(s) to at least three key stakeholders.	10 points Includes a description of the relevance of the topic(s) to two key stakeholders.	6 points Includes a description of the relevance of the topic(s) to one key stakeholder.
Considerations for Practice	12 points Describes at least five considerations for practice related to the topic(s).	10 points Describes at least four considerations for practice related to the topic(s).	6 points Describes three or less considerations for practice related to the topic(s).
Resources	12 points Includes a summary of at least five cited resources to extend your knowledge on the topic(s).	9 points Includes a summary of at least four cited resources to extend your knowledge on the topic(s).	6 points Includes a summary of three or less cited resources to extend your knowledge on the topic(s).
Grammar and Spelling	4 points No grammar or spelling errors.	3 points Some grammar or spelling errors, but none that distract the reader.	1 point Several grammar or spelling errors that distract the reader.
50 points possible			

34



Implementing Practical Modifications and Strategies

Scenario:

Faculty and instructors lack the time to modify their lectures or notes to meet the needs of students.

Potential Solution:

Students can use AI to transcribe lectures (OtterAI), and summarize them based on reading level and comprehension (ChatGPT).

35



Implementing Practical Modifications and Strategies

Scenario:

Faculty and instructors don't know what students are supposed to "get" out of their courses.

Potential Solution:

Work with faculty to develop essential questions that students should be able to answer as a result of attending each class session or taking the course as a whole.

36

Essential Question: Are republicans usually more or less financially conservative than democrats? Has this always been the case? How have republican opinions on government spending changed in the past 30 years?

Essential Question: What options do people have for insurance when they retire? What are five key considerations for ensuring you have the healthcare you need throughout different phases of your life?

Essential Question: What are the three different components of an effective argument?

37

Conclusions

01



WE STILL NEED TO BUILD
AWARENESS!

02



WE CAN ALWAYS LEARN NEW
TIPS AND TRICKS.

03



COMMUNICATE AND REFINE



38

thinkcollegeTA@umb.edu



39

Think College Resources

-  **www.thinkcollege.net**
-  **www.thinkhighered.net**
-  **@IClthinkcollege**
-  **Think College**
-  **@thinkcollegeICI**
-  **@drestinnett**



40